

Reading

The Letter I Never Sent

Before you read

- Have you ever wanted to say sorry to someone but didn't know how to start?
- What makes it hard for people to open up about their feelings?

For almost a year, Deniz and her best friend Ela hadn't spoken. It all started with a small misunderstanding that neither of them had bothered to clear up. Deniz often thought about what she should have done differently. She should have called Ela the same evening instead of waiting for an apology that never came. Looking back, she realised she could have simply asked what had happened instead of assuming the worst.

One evening, Deniz decided to write a letter. She wrote about how she had bottled up her feelings for months, afraid that opening up would make her seem weak. She admitted that she shouldn't have ignored Ela's messages at the beginning, even though she was hurt. She also wrote that Ela must have felt confused when the replies suddenly stopped; there was no other explanation that made sense.

As she wrote, Deniz thought about all the small clues she had missed. Ela had seemed distant at school, and her friends said she looked tired and quiet. Deniz guessed that Ela might have been dealing with something difficult at home, something she couldn't have known about at the time. She felt a wave of guilt. She should have asked instead of staying silent.

In the end, Deniz never sent the letter by post. Instead, she read it aloud to Ela in person, her voice shaking. Ela listened quietly and then said she, too, wished she could have handled things differently. Neither of them had been a bad friend; they had simply been too proud to be vulnerable. By the end of their conversation, the heavy burden both girls had carried for months finally felt lighter.

1. Why hadn't Deniz and Ela spoken for almost a year?
 - a. They had a small misunderstanding they never cleared up.
 - b. They moved to different schools.
 - c. Ela was angry about a birthday present.
 - d. Deniz forgot Ela's phone number.
2. Deniz sent the letter to Ela by post. — *True / False*
3. Deniz guessed that Ela _____ (deal) with something difficult at home.
4. According to the text, what does Deniz criticise herself for?
 - a. Not calling Ela the same evening
 - b. Telling other people about the argument
 - c. Writing too many letters
 - d. Being too talkative at school
5. Rewrite using couldn't have: It was impossible for Deniz to know about Ela's problems at home. (*Deniz ____*)

6. What does the phrase 'a heavy burden' most likely refer to in the text?

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- a. A physical object Deniz carried
- b. The emotional weight of their unresolved conflict
- c. A school assignment
- d. A family responsibility

After you read

- What could Deniz have done earlier to avoid a whole year of silence?
- Do you think writing a letter is a good way to open up? Why or why not?

Who Forgot the Cake?

Before you read

- Think of a time when something went wrong and people started guessing who was responsible.
- What clues do we usually use to guess what happened?

When the Aydın family arrived at their grandmother's 70th birthday party, everyone realised the cake was missing. Panic spread quickly through the kitchen. Someone must have forgotten to pick it up from the bakery, but nobody wanted to admit it. Uncle Kemal insisted he couldn't have forgotten, since he had written the reminder himself on a sticky note stuck to the fridge.

Cousin Aslı suggested that their younger cousin Mert might have taken the sticky note down while cleaning the kitchen that morning. Mert denied it firmly, saying he hadn't touched anything near the fridge. Still, his sister remembered seeing him near the fridge earlier, so he might have moved the note without even noticing.

Meanwhile, Grandma sat calmly in her armchair, smiling. She said it didn't really matter who should have picked up the cake. What mattered more, she explained, was that everyone had come together, worried and a little chaotic, just to make her day special. She reminded them that a missing cake couldn't have ruined a celebration built on love and family.

In the end, they discovered that the bakery itself must have made the mistake — they had accidentally given the cake to another family with a similar name. Everyone laughed with relief. Uncle Kemal joked that he should have called to confirm the order the night before, just to be safe next time. They ordered pizza instead and turned the missing cake into the best story of the year.

1. What was Uncle Kemal's argument for why he couldn't have forgotten the cake?

- a. He never uses sticky notes.
- b. He wrote the reminder himself and stuck it to the fridge.
- c. He doesn't like cake.
- d. He was not at home that morning.

2. Mert _____ (move) the note without noticing, according to his sister.

3. The bakery gave the cake to the wrong family. — *True / False*

4. What did Grandma say mattered more than the missing cake?

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- a. Finding out who was guilty
- b. Everyone coming together for her
- c. Buying a new cake quickly
- d. Getting a refund from the bakery

5. Rewrite using should have: It would have been wise for Kemal to call and confirm the order. (*Kemal* ____)

After you read

- Why do you think the family jumped to conclusions before knowing the real reason?
- How does the story show the difference between guessing (might have) and being certain (must have)?